



A FOUNDER'S PLAYBOOK

AI Wrote The Code. The Hard Part Was Everything Else.

What it actually took to build and launch a real AI product — the honest version, not the highlight reel.

SWIPE →



What 300 hours actually looks like

300

HOURS · 6 WEEKS · OUTSIDE MY DAY JOB

4 days from the first commit to a live site taking real payments. Then weeks of relentless refinement.

*None of those numbers are the point on their own.
What they add up to: every one of them came from a
real decision I made — not a default the AI picked for me.*



WORKED THROUGH, NOT SKIPPED

The unglamorous half of the build

- **A full UI redesign**

five rounds of design iteration, a mobile audit, fixes from testing on real phones

- **SEO from day one**

13 blog posts, structured data, a sitemap, Search Console

- **A domain and trademark question**

worked through properly — a name collision found, checked, and resolved

None of this is glamorous. All of it is why the site works instead of just existing.



QUALITY, TESTED HONESTLY

I built my harshest critics before my next feature

AI agents role-played skeptical parents — different ages, different mindsets — browsing the live site in character, deciding honestly whether they'd pay.

6

ROUNDS OF
TESTING

19

IN-CHARACTER
PARENT SESSIONS

0/3

WOULD HAVE PAID —
ONE HARD ROUND

All three independently found the same flaw: the age “personalisation” was cosmetic, not structural.

It's not a substitute for real customer feedback — I still ask real parents directly, too. Together: a fast first pass, and a real check.



FOR THE TECH-CURIOUS

A fairness bug hiding in the code

THE BUG

Computer Science could never rank as a child's top subject — across 3,000 simulated charts, it won zero times. A scale bug, not a talent gap.

THE FIX

Z-score standardisation — compare each subject to its own typical range, not a raw total. Re-verified against a 6,000-chart simulation.

*Stack: Next.js · TypeScript · Supabase · Stripe · real
ephemeris-based astronomical calculation, not templates.*



FOR THE PRODUCT-CURIOUS

Research first, not a blind leap

- **Competitive gap**

Every direct competitor missed at least one of 5 things: real calculation, child-specific content, global tone, modern UX, honest positioning.

- **Channel strategy**

Paid social is a poor fit for this category. Organic content, SEO and Pinterest lead instead — backed by real case data, not guesswork.

- **Platform risk**

Payment processors restrict this category, so every word on the site was framed around education and parenting — never fortune-telling.

**Realistic projection: \$300-\$2,000/month within
12-18 months of consistent content effort.**



Astrology has run in my family for years

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I've practised astrology for years, as a passionate hobby that runs in my family. With my own two kids, I used it as one more lens for understanding their strengths and how to support them better.

I wanted to offer that same reflection to other parents — and build a content-driven income stream along the way. Not passive: it takes ongoing work.

It's a starting point for conversations about a child — not a prediction. The site says so plainly.



5 things I'd tell anyone building with AI

1

Give your AI a memory

No session remembers the last one — keep a running build log.

2

Set your constraints first

Ethical and legal lines, decided before a word of copy is written.

3

Build your harshest critic first

Adversarial testing before scaling, every time.

4

Pause, don't delete

Park what isn't ready behind a flag — come back when it's right.

5

The uncomfortable result is the useful one

Every hard finding made the product better.



THE REAL SHIFT

**AI doesn't replace
judgement.**

**It multiplies whatever
judgement you bring.**

- Breaking a messy idea into clean systems
- Arguing against your own assumptions
- Setting guardrails before you build
- Knowing what to ship, park, or fix



Read the full story

The full playbook — the tech-curious details, the product research, and every lesson learned — is in the article. Link in the comments below.

littlestargazer.com

See the product this whole story is about

*If you're building with AI — or deciding how to —
I'd love to compare notes. Connect below.*

#AI #Startups #ProductManagement #BuildInPublic